



construction; and transportation, both private and logistics.

Despite the current government's commitment to climate action and hitting the target of net zero by 2070, the new government that will be in place around June has to recharge efforts to phase out fossil fuels and invest in technologies. The green lobby wants to eliminate the use of fossil fuels, reduce emissions, and sustainable growth. It is up to the private sector and governments to figure out how to do it without killing the economy. India needs a comprehensive approach towards renewable energy that integrates government policies, technological advancements, financial incentives, and the community's involvement.

CHARTING A GREEN COURSE

1 India is the third-largest carbon emitter. Carbon emissions in the country will peak between 2040 and 2045 before beginning a gradual fall

2 India is facing the critical challenge of reducing GHG emissions and transitioning to a low-carbon economy

3 India has been actively working towards achieving net zero by 2070 ever since it committed to it at COP26 in November 2021

4 As part of the 2023-24 Union Budget, \$4.3 billion was allocated for priority capital investments towards energy transition initiatives, net-zero objectives, and energy security targets

5 India needs to integrate government policies, technical advances, financial incentives, and community involvement in the next five years to reach net zero

RENEWABLE IS THE KEYWORD

India's priority is economic growth aimed at powering hundreds of millions out of poverty, but such growth will cause energy demand to surge. The way out? A rapid increase in the use of renewable energy. Easier said than done.

The Carbon Markets Association of India (CMAI), which brings together industry experts working for a structured carbon trading system, says targets, investments, efficiency and affordability are the pillars of a renewable energy strategy.

"The government should look to reinforce policies supporting renewable energy, offering incentives, tax benefits, and a stable regulatory environment to attract investments. Financial incentives, including subsidies and low-interest loans, would make renewable projects more financially viable," says Manish Dabkara, chairman and MD EKI Energy Services Ltd and President of CMAI. "Grid infrastructure improvement and investment in energy storage solutions are crucial for accommodating the intermittent nature of solar and wind power," Dabkara says. | 247

Sameer Jain, managing director of Primus Partners, a business and management consulting firm, says innovations in technology will drive this transition. "Increasing research and development funding for advanced renewables like offshore wind, floating solar, and green hydrogen production will open new possibilities for clean energy," says Jain. He says India has to increase the manufacture of equipment and parts used in renewable energy systems to reduce costs, create jobs, and work out smart grid technologies and microgrid solutions to make power grids flexible and resilient.